

» VIJAY HAZARE DIARY

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THE BEAUTY OF DOMESTIC CRICKET: BEYOND THE LIMELIGHT

Our correspondents bring you the highlights and intriguing moments, both on and off the field, from the group stages of Vijay Hazare Trophy.

A domestic cricket game in the country often unfolds as a scene of tranquillity, far removed from the clamour of bouncing franchise team supporters and loud DJs blaring out their mixtapes. Even the 1,32,000-seater Narendra Modi Stadium in Ahmedabad lay in all its barrenness

during the Vijay Hazare Trophy encounter between Karnataka and Pondicherry.

Despite the absence of spectators in the stands, some unexpected visitors made an appearance at the game. A troupe of langurs was spotted a few metres above the sight screen, creating a clunking sound as they hopped across the metal

platforms erected for the broadcast cameras. They didn't stick around for the cricket to start, seemingly content with watching the players warm up before climbing their way above the third umpire's box and vanishing into the distance.

In contrast, the ADSA Railway Ground, where Mumbai faced Punjab, was a stark departure from